

Criteria for Proceeding to Wider Bureau Deployment

Document Reference: CAW-PILOT-GATE-2026-01
System: Case Ace v2.0 Client Consultation Recording & Note Drafting System
Organisation: Citizens Advice Wandsworth (CAW)
Standard: Advice Quality Standard (AQS Level 3) & ISO/IEC 42001:2023
Target Scope: Full Rollout to all 45 Generalist Advisers & 30 Volunteer Caseworkers
Status: Formally Approved Gating Policy
Classification: Internal / Operational

1. Executive Summary & Gating Philosophy

The transition from the 15-adviser pilot to full, bureau-wide operational deployment across Citizens Advice Wandsworth (Battersea, Roehampton, Wandsworth Town, and all outreach clinics) is strictly gate-controlled.

Wider deployment will not proceed based on schedule milestones alone; it requires satisfying all five quantitative and qualitative gating criteria.

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graph LR
    A["Pilot Concludes (250 Cases)"] --> B["Gate 1: AQS Quality >= 95%"]
    B --> C["Gate 2: Zero Privacy Breaches (0 PII Leaks)"]
    C --> D["Gate 3: EqIA & ASR Parity Audit"]
    D --> E["Gate 4: Time Efficiency >= 50% Savings"]
    E --> F["Gate 5: Formal Trustee & DPO Sign-Off"]
    F --> G["Bureau-Wide Rollout Approved"]
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2. Five Mandatory Deployment Gating Criteria

MANDATORY GATING CRITERIA FOR WIDER DEPLOYMENT		
Gate Category	Mandatory Quantitative / Qualitative Threshold	Status
Gate 1: AQS Quality	$\geq 95.0\%$ blind audit pass rate across pilot; $\leq 0.5\%$ rate of unrecorded statutory deadlines.	MANDATORY
Gate 2: Privacy	Exactly 0 confirmed PII leaks to cloud endpoints; 100% verification of zero client-side disk storage.	MANDATORY (Zero Leak)
Gate 3: Equality	Disparity in ASR accuracy across accent/disability cohorts $\leq 2.5\%$; 0 accessibility defects.	MANDATORY (PSED Review)
Gate 4: Efficiency	Average case note authoring time $\leq 8.0\text{ mins}$; $\geq 50\%$ time savings; Adviser score $\geq 4.0/5.0$	MANDATORY
Gate 5: Governance	Unanimous written sign-off from DPO, Quality Manager, Head of Operations, and Board of Trustees.	MANDATORY (Board Auth)

3. Detailed Gating Evaluation Protocols

Gate 1: AQS Level 3 Quality Verification

Evaluation Body: CAW Quality & Standards Committee.

Requirement:

A minimum of 50 randomly sampled Casebook notes drafted during the pilot are blind-audited by senior supervisors.

At least 95.0% of audited notes must meet or exceed AQS Level 3 standards.

Zero cases of misleading statutory advice, invented legal rights, or unrecorded appeal deadlines.

Gate 2: Information Security & Data Protection Compliance

Evaluation Body: Data Protection Officer & External IT Auditor.

Requirement:

Comprehensive inspection of backend audit logs, verifying that 100% of telemetry payloads conformed strictly to the non-PII whitelist schema.

Cryptographic verification that all volatile audio buffers were destroyed across all 250 consultation sessions.

Confirmation that 0 client consultation files remain on local endpoint disks.

Gate 3: Equality, Accessibility & Fairness Audit

Evaluation Body: Equality, Diversity & Inclusion (EDI) Lead.

Requirement:

Analysis of ASR transcription accuracy confirms that error rate disparity between standard UK English and diverse accents (West African, South Asian, Eastern European) is $\leq 2.5\%$ percentage points.

Conformance with WCAG 2.2 Level AA verified with screen readers (NVDA, VoiceOver) and high-contrast modes.

Positive feedback from volunteer advisers with disabilities.

Gate 4: Caseworker Efficiency and Experience

Evaluation Body: Operational Service Managers.

Requirement:

Measured average drafting and review time is ≤ 8.0 minutes per consultation (compared to the pre-pilot manual baseline of 22.5 minutes).

Adviser satisfaction index is ≥ 4.0 out of 5.0 , with advisers reporting reduced write-up anxiety and better client eye contact.

4. Formal Governance Sign-Off & Approval Record